06-14 第二篇

Learning a Second Language

Learning a second language opens doors to new cultures, ideas, and opportunities. Whether you study English, Mandarin, Spanish, or any other language, the benefits go far beyond passing exams. [1] In other words, a second language broadens your mind and connects you to millions of people around the world. It helps you understand different ways of thinking, makes travel easier, and can even boost your career in the future.

The best time to start is early—but it is never too late. [2] Young children often pick up new languages naturally through exposure, games, and conversation. However, research shows that teenagers and adults can also learn languages well if they use effective methods. The key is regular practice: a little bit every day works better than cramming（死记硬背）before a test. Listening to songs, watching films with subtitles（字幕）, and chatting with native speakers online are all useful ways to improve. Mistakes are part of the process—do not be afraid to speak and make errors.

Language learning trains your brain. [3] Studies show that people who speak more than one language often have better memory, problem-solving skills, and even delayed cognitive decline in old age. Learning grammar and vocabulary exercises different parts of the brain. Switching between languages improves mental flexibility—the ability to shift focus and adapt to new situations. In short, language learning is like a gym for your mind, and the effects last a lifetime.

Staying motivated can be challenging. [4] Progress in language learning is often slow and uneven; you might feel stuck for weeks and then suddenly improve. Setting small, clear goals—such as "learn five new words today" or "watch one short video in the target language"—helps maintain momentum. Finding a language partner, joining an online community, or planning a trip to a place where the language is spoken can renew your motivation. Remember why you started: the joy of understanding a new song, making a friend abroad, or reading a book in its original language.

[5] Learning a second language is an investment in yourself that pays dividends for life. It takes time and effort, but the rewards—cultural insight, new friendships, and a sharper mind—are worth it. Start small, stay curious, and enjoy the journey. Every word you learn brings you closer to a bigger world.

选项

A. In other words, a second language expands your horizons and connects you to the world. B. That is because consistent practice and varied methods work better than occasional, intense study. C. In fact, bilingualism supports memory, problem-solving, and

mental flexibility. D. These strategies help learners stay motivated when progress feels slow. E. In short, learning a second language is a lifelong investment with lasting rewards. F. For example, English is the most widely used second language in the world.

答案键（Answer Key）

[1] A [2] B [3] C [4] D [5] E

深度解析

- **[1] A**：
  - **线索**：引出第二语言对视野与全球联系的价值。空前描述"Learning a second language opens doors to new cultures, ideas, opportunities...benefits go far beyond passing exams"，空后说明"a second language broadens your mind and connects you to millions of people...understand different ways of thinking, makes travel easier, can boost career"。A选项"In other words, a second language expands your horizons and connects you to the world"（换言之，第二语言拓展你的视野并将你与世界连接）中"In other words"概括空前，"expands horizons...connects you to the world"与空后"broadens mind...connects to millions"精准呼应，衔接顺畅。
- **[2] B**：
  - **线索**：持续、多样化的练习优于突击学习。空前提出"The best time to start is early—but it is never too late"，空后详述"Young children pick up naturally...teenagers and adults can learn well with effective methods...key is regular practice: little bit every day better than cramming...Listening to songs, watching films with subtitles, chatting with native speakers...Mistakes part of process"。B选项"That is because consistent practice and varied methods work better than occasional, intense study"（那是因为持续练习和多样方法比偶尔的密集学习更有效）中"That is because"解释学习方法，"consistent practice and varied methods...better than cramming"与空后 regular practice、songs/films/chatting 完美对应，逻辑紧密。
- **[3] C**：
  - **线索**：双语对认知能力的促进作用。空前提出"Language learning trains your brain"，空后列举"Studies: people who speak more than one language have better memory, problem-solving, delayed cognitive decline...grammar and vocabulary exercise different parts of brain...Switching between languages improves mental flexibility...gym for your mind...effects last lifetime"。C选项"In fact, bilingualism supports memory, problem-solving, and mental flexibility"（事实上，双语能力有助于记忆、问题解决和心理灵活性）中"In fact"强

化认知益处，"memory, problem-solving, mental flexibility"与空后 better memory、problem-solving、mental flexibility 精准对应，衔接自然。

- [4] D：
  - **线索**：保持学习动力的策略。空前提出"Staying motivated can be challenging"，空后描述"Progress often slow and uneven...feel stuck for weeks then improve...Setting small, clear goals...helps maintain momentum...Finding language partner, joining community, planning trip...renew motivation...Remember why you started"。D选项"These strategies help learners stay motivated when progress feels slow"（这些策略帮助学习者在进步缓慢时保持动力）中"These strategies"指代空后小目标、语伴、社群、旅行等，"stay motivated when progress feels slow"与空后"slow and uneven...feel stuck...maintain momentum...renew motivation"完美对应，衔接得当。
- [5] E：
  - **线索**：全文收束与语言学习的长期回报。空[5]位于结尾段段首，空后总结"Learning a second language is investment in yourself that pays dividends for life...takes time and effort, but rewards—cultural insight, new friendships, sharper mind—worth it...Start small, stay curious...Every word brings you closer to bigger world"。E选项"In short, learning a second language is a lifelong investment with lasting rewards"（简言之，学习第二语言是带来持久回报的终身投资）用"In short"总结全文，"lifelong investment with lasting rewards"与空后"pays dividends for life...rewards worth it"形成呼应，收束精准。
- **干扰项分析**：
  - **F. For example, English is the most widely used second language in the world.**：涉及英语为最广泛使用的第二语言，易被误填[1]或[2]。但F以"For example"引出英语这一语种，而空[1]讨论的是第二语言学习的普遍益处，F的"English"为单一语种案例，与"broadens mind...connects to millions"的普世价值论述焦点不同；空[2]讨论学习时机与方法，F的"most widely used"与练习方法、时机无关。F属"主题相关但论述角度错位"型干扰。